

Ordering Best Practices

Grocery, Frozen, Dairy



Pre-Order Conditions

1. Stockroom should be fully organized

- No mixed or loose cases.
- Overstock and duplicate items are identified.
- Pathways are clear and safe for access.

Key Principle: Any item in the stockroom must be easy to locate and count within seconds.

2. Retail Shelves should be fully worked and blocked

- All available backstock has been stocked to the shelf.
- Shelves are:
 - Blocked and aligned in neat rows.
 - Filled to capacity where appropriate.
- No empty space should exist due to unworked backstock.

Key Principle: Shelf condition must reflect true on-hand inventory before ordering.

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Pre-Order Conditions

3. Checkpoint: Does the item and tag match?

- Every product on the shelf:
 - Should match the correct price tag.
 - Should be in correct location according to the planogram.
- No plugged items are allowed. (Wrong item, in wrong place)
- Missing or incorrect tags should be corrected before ordering.



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Pre-Order Conditions

4. Accurate On-Hand Inventory Verification

- Physically verify counts for:
 - Out-of-stock items.
 - Low-stock items.
- Cross-check shelf and backstock totals.
- Cross-check shelf and Promotional Displays. If the shelf is empty transfer product from Dump Bins, Ends Caps, or any secondary promotional sections to fill the shelf.
- Identify slow-moving or excess inventory. (What's the plan to sell?)

5. Backstock Must Be Minimized

- Be sure that excess inventory is:
 - Worked to shelf where possible.
 - Consolidated and organized.
- Overstock issues are recognized before reordering.

Key Principle: The stockroom should support the sales floor, not replace it.

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Pre-Order Conditions

Order Authorization

An order may only be placed once:

- All pre-order conditions are completed.
- Shelf and stock room alignment is confirmed.

Accountability

- The department lead or manager must verify completion.
- Orders placed without meeting these conditions may require correction.

Key Principle: Fix the store before you fill the store.

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Ordering Process

1. Identify True Order Needs

- Walk each section and recognize:
 - Out-of-stock items
 - Low stock items
- Order with consideration to the Weekly Movement printed on the tag.



If the shelf tag says that you sell 48 units per week;

1. Compare this number to the number of units that you have on-hand.
2. If you have enough on hand to last until next truck do not order until then.

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Ordering Process

2. Validate Against Backstock

- Reaffirm your knowledge of existing Stockroom Inventory.
- If backstock is high on a particular item, reduce or eliminate the order quantity.

Rule: Never order what you already own in excess.

3. Build the Order in the System

- Develop an Isle Ordering Sequence that you follow each time that you order.
- Be sure to check Inventory levels on bulk / pallet order inventory in stockroom.
E.g. Water Pallets
- Double-check:
 - UPC numbers. Are they the same on the item and tag.
 - Build-To Quantities.
 - Vendor specifics.

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Ordering Process

6. Review for Balance and Efficiency

Ensure the order:

- Considers weekly average movement per item.
- Does not create excess backstock.

7. Final Order Audit

Before submitting:

- Walk key sections again and confirm no outs were missed.
- Verify:
 - All items have shelf space.
 - Quantities are reasonable.
- Spot-check the top 10 to 20 selling items.

8. Submit Order

- Submit within the required timeline.
- Ensure compliance with the delivery schedule.

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Post-Order Expectations

The order should:

- Go directly to the shelf with minimal backstock.
- Support clean, full, and properly blocked displays.

The stocking team should be able to:

- Quickly work product without reorganizing.

Accountability

The department lead is responsible for:

- Accuracy of the order.
- Adherence to the process.

Store leadership may review:

- Overstock issues.
- Out-of-stock trends.

Key Principle:

- **Order for the shelf, not the stockroom.**

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Milk Orders

- Always refer to pre-determined build to minimums before ordering.
- E.g. If a milk variety build-to order quantity is 33 and you have 2 on hand, you will need to order 31.

Milk Build_To Sheet Delivery Date _____

Item Description	Size	Pack	Build ON HAND To	ORDER CASES	Ord #
ALWAYS SAVE 2% RF MILK	128 OZ	4	33		105231
ALWAYS SAVE WHOLE MILK	128 OZ	4	110		105214
BCSS EGG NOG	32 OZ	12	3		114215
BST CH 1% BUTTERMILK	64 OZ	9	0		105285
BSTCH 1% BTRMLK	32 OZ	9	3		105370
BSTCH 1% CHOC MILK	64 OZ	9	0		105267
BSTCH 1% LF MILK	128 OZ	4	4		105209
BSTCH 1% LF MILK	64 OZ	9	3		105256
BSTCH 2% RF MILK	64 OZ	9	42		105254
BSTCH 2% RF MILK	32 OZ	9	3		105287

Submitted by _____ Order by Case

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Pre-Order Checklist

Store Readiness (Must Complete First)

Stock Room

- ☐ No mixed or loose cases
- ☐ Overstock and duplicates identified
- ☐ All product organized and easy to locate
- ☐ Aisles clear and safe

Sales Floor

- ☐ All backstock worked to shelf
- ☐ Shelves filled to capacity where appropriate
- ☐ Shelves blocked and faced properly
- ☐ No empty space due to unworked product

Pricing & Planogram

- ☐ All items match correct price tags
- ☐ All products in correct location
- ☐ No plugged items
- ☐ Missing/incorrect tags corrected

Inventory Accuracy

- ☐ Out-of-stocks physically verified
- ☐ Low-stock items physically counted
- ☐ Shelf + backstock totals confirmed
- ☐ Slow movers and excess identified

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Backstock Control

- ☐ Backstock minimized
 - ☐ Excess worked to shelf where possible
 - ☐ Overstock consolidated and addressed
-



Ordering

Identify Needs

- ☐ Walk all sections
 - ☐ low or Out-of-stocks
 - ☐ Decisions based on weekly movement (not estimates)
-

Validate Inventory

- ☐ No excess backstock exists
- ☐ Product Orders reduced or eliminated if inventory already available

Item Authorization

- ☐ Item has shelf location
- ☐ Item has valid price tag
- ☐ Item fits planogram
- ☐ No unauthorized items
- ☐ No discontinued/duplicate items

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Build Order

- ☐ Items entered correctly
 - ☐ Case pack sizes followed
 - ☐ Item numbers verified
 - ☐ Quantities verified
 - ☐ Vendor details correct
-

Review Order

- ☐ Supports full, blocked shelves
 - ☐ No excess backstock created
 - ☐ High-volume items sufficient
 - ☐ Slow movers controlled
-

Final Audit

- ☐ Store walked again
- ☐ No missed outs
- ☐ All items have shelf space
- ☐ Top 10–20 items spot-checked

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Submission

- ☐ Submitted on time
 - ☐ Delivery schedule confirmed
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Manager Sign-Off

- ☐ All pre-order conditions met
- ☐ Inventory accuracy confirmed
- ☐ Order reviewed for accuracy

Manager Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____



Key Reminders

- Fix the store before you fill the store.
- Order for the shelf, not the stockroom.
- Never order what you already own.